

Ornithopods

Ornithopod means “bird feet” and many of these dinosaurs were small and quick. Some switched between walking on two or four legs. Although they were bulky, ornithopods were plant-eaters and many had beaks for collecting leaves. Some may have lived in herds for safety.

Iguanodon

This huge ornithopod had a sharp thumb spike on each hand to defend itself against predators. Iguanodon was the first plant-eating dinosaur discovered, with fossils found in England in 1822.

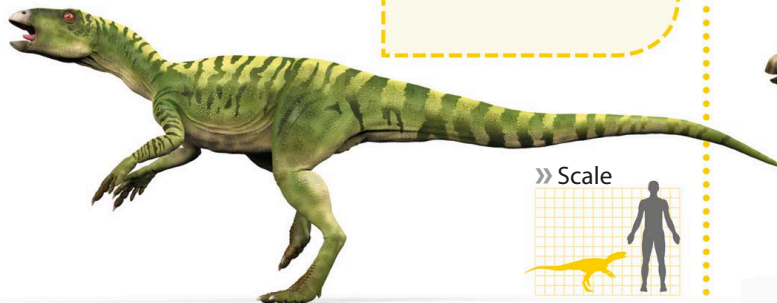


Hypsilophodon

Faced with the decision of fight or flight, this small ornithopod had a choice. It could flee at speed or bite or kick its attacker with the claws on its toes.

FACT FILE

- » **When:** Early Cretaceous
- » **Length:** 6 ft (2 m)
- » **Fun fact:** Scientists once thought that Hypsilophodon lived in the trees.



Ouranosaurus

The sweltering heat of Africa was home for duck-billed Ouranosaurus. A large, spiny sail running along its back might have been boldly patterned and was probably used as a display feature.

